FROM IDEA TO DEPLOYMENT

BUILDING YOUR FIRST REAL PROJECT

WHY ARE YOU HERE?

01 You know how to code

02 You're curious about building real projects

03 You're maybe a little nervous

04 You want to prove to yourself you can do this

MOST STUDENTS NEVER BUILD

FEAR. OVERTHINKING. PERFECTIONISM.

YOU DON'T NEED TO KNOW EVERYTHING

SHIPPING OVER PERFECTION

- Professional developers Google things every day.
- AI tools (GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT) are your friends.
- "Good enough" beats "perfect but never shipped".

FROM IDEA TO MVP

4 SIMPLE STEPS

01 **PROBLEM**

What's the pain point?

02 **SOLUTION**

How do you fix it?

03 **BENEFITS**

Why should anyone care?

04 **MVP**

What's the absolute minimum?

REAL EXAMPLE: PERSONAL PORTFOLIO

01 / PROBLEM

"I need a place to show my projects."

02 / SOLUTION

Build a website with projects, bio, and contact info.

03 / BENEFITS

Recruiters can find you; you look professional.

04 / MVP

1 page, 3 projects, links to GitHub & LinkedIn.

KEEP IT SIMPLE: TECH STACK 101

ARCHITECTURE

01

FRONTEND

React (template) OR HTML/CSS/JS. Keep it to what you know.

02

BACKEND

Optional. Python or JavaScript if you absolutely need it.

03

DEPLOYMENT

Vercel. One click, seriously. Free and fast.

04

AI TOOLS

GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT. Use them! They're your friends.

HOW IT ALL FITS TOGETHER

THE DEPLOYMENT FLOW

1. You update code → push to GitHub → Vercel auto-deploys.
2. User visits your Vercel link → sees your live app.

FROM GITHUB TO LIVE: VERCEL MAGIC

DEPLOYMENT

GITHUB REPO

Connect your GitHub repo to Vercel in two minutes.

VERCEL MAGIC

Vercel automatically rebuilds and deploys on every push.

LIVE URL

Your app is live at a unique URL. Share the link!

[LIVE DEMO]

LET'S BUILD: PERSONAL PORTFOLIO

Watch me build and deploy a real project in 15 minutes.

[LIVE DEMO]

CLONE TEMPLATE

```
git clone
https://github.com/example/portfolio-template.gi
t
```

[LIVE DEMO]

RUN LOCALLY

```
cd portfolio-template
```

```
npm install
```

```
npm run dev
```

GIT: THE 3 COMMANDS YOU NEED

```
git add .
```

STAGE ALL YOUR CHANGES

```
git commit -m "msg"
```

SAVE A SNAPSHOT

```
git push
```

SEND IT TO GITHUB

[LIVE DEMO]

GIT & PUSH

01

```
git add .
```

Stage the changes we just made to the portfolio.

02

```
git commit -m "update"
```

Save the snapshot with a descriptive message.

03

```
git push
```

Send the updated code to our GitHub repository.

[LIVE DEMO]

DEPLOY TO VERCEL

01 Go to vercel.com and log in with GitHub.

02 Click "Add New Project" and import your repository.

03 Click "Deploy". Wait 30 seconds.

IT'S LIVE!

YOUR PORTFOLIO IS NOW ON THE INTERNET.

https://your-name.vercel.app

WHAT WE JUST DID

15

MINUTES

RECAP

01 Cloned a template from GitHub

02 Ran it locally to see it work

03 Pushed our code to a new repository

04 Deployed it live to the world via Vercel

NOW IT'S YOUR TURN

CHOOSE YOUR PATH

PATH A

THE TEMPLATE

Clone the provided portfolio template. Customize the content. Deploy it to Vercel. A guaranteed win for your first deployment.

PATH B

YOUR IDEA

Start from scratch. Build your own MVP using the Ideation Framework. Deploy it. Higher risk, higher reward.

[HANDS-ON]

SETUP

01 Choose your path (Template or Scratch)

02 Create a new GitHub repository

03 Clone it to your local machine

[HANDS-ON]

BUILD

01 Open the project folder in VS Code

02 Customize the name, bio, and links

03 Run local server to test changes

[HANDS-ON]

COMMIT & PUSH

```
git add .
```

```
git commit -m "update"
```

```
git push origin main
```

[HANDS-ON]

DEPLOY

01 Go to Vercel and log in with GitHub.

02 Import the repository you just pushed.

03 Leave default settings and click "Deploy".

STUCK?
HERE'S HELP

TROUBLESHOOTING

01

GIT ERRORS

Check if you added files before committing. If you're stuck in a weird state, ask a mentor for help.

02

VERCEL BUILD FAILED

Click on the failed build in Vercel and check the logs. It's usually a missing dependency or a typo.

03

BLANK SCREEN

Check your browser console for errors. Did you run `npm install`? Did you save your files?

DON'T MAKE THESE MISTAKES

TOMORROW & BEYOND

OVERBUILDING

Trying to add too many features instead of focusing on the core MVP.

NOT SHIPPING

Waiting for the project to be "perfect" before deploying.

BAD TEAMWORK

Not communicating or failing to divide tasks effectively.

AT THIS POINT

YOU ARE CAPABLE

- ✓ You built a project
- ✓ You used Git
- ✓ You deployed to the internet

YOUR CHALLENGE

DAY 2 & 3

DAY 02

Form teams, pick an idea, and build the MVP. Focus on core functionality.

DAY 03

Polish your project, deploy it to Vercel, and present it to the group.

QUESTIONS?

LET'S BUILD SOMETHING AMAZING

SEE YOU TOMORROW